



Bringing Emotional Intelligence into Work Management

Designing work around people using AI to reduce digital fatigue

Presented By

DOF - Department of Future

Meet the DOF Team

| "Before we begin, let me introduce our team."



Mei Qiong Xue



Jinyi Yuan



Ishan Vaghani



**Qunfeng Zhou
(Fung)**



**Yu-Erh Li
(Ariana)**

Human-Aware Workflow in Action



The Assignment

Employee: Jinyi (China office)

Manager: Ariana (United States)

Task: Complex, 2-week project

Initial assessment: Manageable



The Realization

Event: Chinese New Year approaching

Context: Most important holiday, week-long family time off

Conflict: Deadline doesn't account for holiday

System Fails to Recognize:

Upcoming holiday

Reduced availability

Actual workload required



The Difficult Position

Ariana's view: On track, timeline reasonable

Jinyi's reality: Stuck in a stressful dilemma

Jinyi's Stressful Choice:

Work overtime before holiday?

Sacrifice time off?

Risk falling behind?

The Modern Work Problem

9,000+

knowledge workers
surveyed globally

84%

experience digital
exhaustion

77%

report unmanageable
workloads

The Friction & The System Gap

The Friction: **Dynamic Work vs. Rigid Systems**

-  Teams collaborate globally across multiple tools and shifting priorities.
-  Global collaboration introduces constant time zone and scheduling constraints.
-  Traditional workflows still depend heavily on manual delegation.
-  Current rules are static and do not adjust to changing workload availability.

Key Takeaway

Work today is dynamic — but coordination systems are still rigid.

Current Tools **Miss the Human Layer**

-  Platforms organize work effectively, but they are not designed around people.
-  Systems track tasks, but they do not measure human capacity.
-  Tools manage strict deadlines, but they ignore cognitive overload.
-  Software optimizes structural workflows, but fails to account for real human constraints.

The System Gap

We lack a platform that understands whether people can actually handle the assigned work.

Our Proposal



The Core Shift

Transform Asana from a task management tool into a **human-aware, intelligent work platform.**



Integrate EI into AI

Embed emotional intelligence into AI models to better understand people, not just what they do.



Dynamic Workloads

Automatically adjust task distribution based on real-time human capacity, availability, and context.



Intelligent Signals

Leverage signals like calendars, deadlines and team activity patterns to optimize execution timing.



Human-Centered Results

Significantly reduce burnout risks while simultaneously improving team productivity and strategic alignment.

Our Projects & AI Powered Rules

Availability Checking System

OverviewListBoardTimelineDashboard

+ Add task

Name	Estimated Weeks Spent	Due date	Assignee	Region	Workload Score	Availability Risk	Pressure Risk	Recommended Action
Add Task to Check								
Add task...								

Workload Tracking

OverviewListBoardTimelineDashboardWorkload

+ Add task

Name	Assignee	Due date	Workload score
1.Phase One: Planning			
Define workload management framework		Friday	
1.1	Qunfeng Zhou	Oct 6	1.0
1.2	Jinyi Yuan	Apr 23	1.0
1.3	Yu-Erh	Tomorrow	1.0
1.4	Yu-Erh	Oct 13	1.0
Add task...			SUM 4.0
2.Phase Two: Setup & Configuration			
Setup Completed			
2.1	Yu-Erh	Apr 16	1.0
2.2	Ishan Vaghani	Apr 17	1.0

China Mainland	1.0	Not Avail...	Low	⚠️⚠️⚠️ Reassign this tas...
China Mainland	1.0	No Risk	Low	✅✅✅ Task is on track—...
India	0.0	Not Fully ...	Low	! This task may conflict wi...

Company Directory

OverviewListBoardTimelineDashboard

+ Add task

Name	Region
Qunfeng Zhou	China Mainland
Mei Qiong Xue	United States
Ishan Vaghani	India
Yu-Erh	Taiwan
Jinyi Yuan	China Mainland
Add task...	
+ Add section	

Rules with AI Studio

+ Add

Added to project

Manage tasks and workflows automatically.

Region Fulfilling

Active · Last run 2 hours ago

Workload Fulfilling

Active · Last run 2 hours ago

Workload Risk Level

Active · Last run 2 hours ago

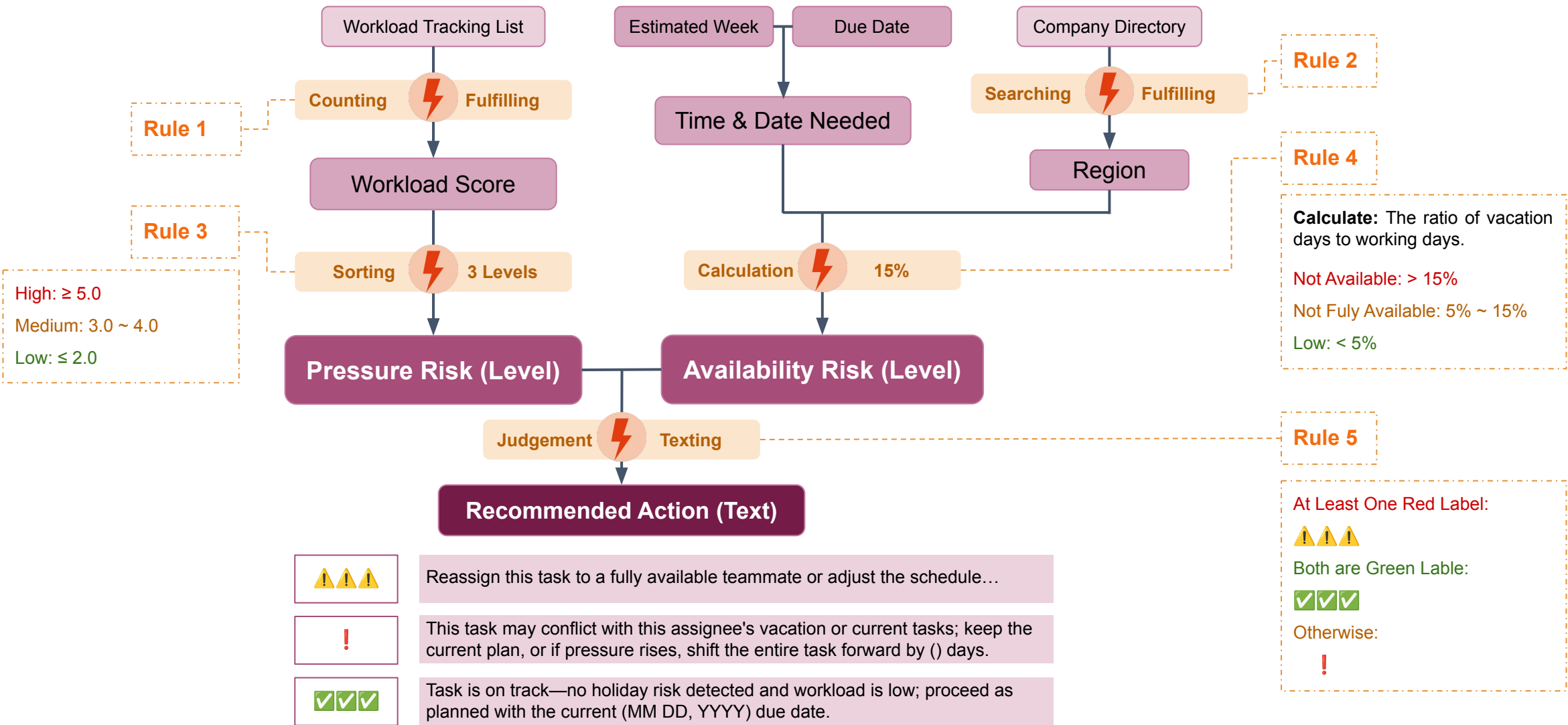
AI Global Holiday Router

Active · Last run 2 hours ago

Final Recommendation

Active · Last run 2 hours ago

How AI Rules Fits Into the Workflow



Live Example - Project Manager POV

Before:

OverviewListBoardTimelineDashboard+

+ Add task

FilterSortGroup

Name	Estimated Weeks Spent	Due date	Assignee	Region	Workload Score	Avalibility Risk	Pressure Risk	Recommended Action
▼ Add Task to Check								
✓ Preparation and handover work of Global Event	2	Feb 17, 2027	JY Jinyi Yuan					
Add task...	SUM	2						

After:

Name	Assignee	Region	Workload Score	Avalibility Risk	Pressure Risk	Recommended Action	
▼ Add Task to Check							
Add task...							
▼ Checked ⚡							
✓ Preparation and handover work of Global Event	JY Jinyi Yuan	China Mainland	5.0	Not Avail...	High	⚠️⚠️⚠️ Reassign this task to a fully available teammate or adjust the schedule to reduce availability/holiday conflicts and workload pressure.	
✓ Pilot Survey: Shanghai	QZ Qunfeng Zhou	China Mainland	1.0	No Risk	Low		
✓ Pilot Survey: Milan	IV Ishan Vaghani	India	0.0	Not Fully ...	Low	! This task may conflict wi...	
✓ Pilot Survey: Tokyo	JY Jinyi Yuan	China Mainland	0.0	No Risk	Low	✅✅✅ Task is on track—...	

Live Example - The Solution

Name	Assignee	Region	Workload Score	Avalibility Risk	Pressure Risk	Recommended Action	+
▼ Add Task to Check							
Add task...							
▼ Checked ⚡							
✓ Preparation and handover work of Global Event	IV Ishan Vaghani	India	1.0	No Risk	Low	✓✓✓ Task is on track—no holiday risk detected and workload is low; proceed as planned with the current Feb 17, 2027 due date.	
✓ Pilot Survey: Shanghai	QZ Qunfeng Zhou	China Mainland	1.0	No Risk	Low		
—							

“

“Behind every task is a **person — and that’s who we should design for.”**

Thank you.

Questions?